EDENBRIDGE GRAMMAR
BEYOND SCHOOLING

Edenbridge Grammar

Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy

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1. Policy Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to set out Edenbridge Grammar's comprehensive approach to safeguarding and child protection. The school is committed to ensuring that every child is protected from harm, feels safe within the school community, and is supported to flourish academically, emotionally, socially, and morally.

This policy reflects Edenbridge Grammar's responsibilities under Pakistani child protection laws and regulations, aligns with recognised best practice in education and child wellbeing, and upholds high ethical standards in learning, pastoral care, digital engagement, and professional conduct. Safeguarding is understood not as a single procedure, but as a shared responsibility embedded into all aspects of school life.

This policy applies to all members of the school community, including staff, leadership, visiting professionals, volunteers, students, parents, and any adult engaged in school-related activities, whether on-site or online.

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2. Definition of Safeguarding

Safeguarding at Edenbridge Grammar refers to the actions taken to protect children from abuse, neglect, exploitation, and harm, while also promoting their overall wellbeing and development. This includes preventing impairment of a child's physical or mental health, ensuring children grow up in safe and effective care, and taking timely action to enable the best possible outcomes for every learner.

Safeguarding is both protective and preventative. It encompasses not only responding to concerns but also creating an environment in which children feel secure, respected, listened to, and supported.

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3. Legal, Cultural, and Ethical Context in Pakistan

Edenbridge Grammar operates in accordance with child protection legislation and safeguarding expectations within Pakistan, including engagement with relevant provincial child protection authorities when required. The school recognises the importance of working sensitively within the cultural, religious, and family contexts of the community it serves.

Safeguarding practice at Edenbridge Grammar is firmly guided by the principle that **the welfare of the child is paramount**. Where there is a conflict between adult interests, institutional convenience, or cultural sensitivities and the safety of a child, the child's wellbeing always takes precedence.

Where concerns indicate a serious risk of harm, the school will act decisively and, where necessary, involve external authorities in line with legal obligations.

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4. Forms of Harm and Risk

Edenbridge Grammar recognises that harm can take many forms and may occur in physical, emotional, social, or digital contexts. Staff are trained to recognise indicators of physical abuse, emotional or psychological harm, sexual abuse or exploitation, neglect, bullying and harassment, and inappropriate behaviour by adults or peers.

The school also recognises the growing risks associated with online activity, including exposure to harmful content, inappropriate communication, emotional distress, or misuse of digital tools. Safeguarding procedures apply equally to face-to-face and digital environments.

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5. Roles and Responsibilities

Safeguarding is a collective responsibility, with clearly defined roles to ensure accountability and clarity.

The Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL) holds overall responsibility for safeguarding and child protection within the school. The DSL oversees safeguarding procedures, receives and records concerns, coordinates responses, and liaises with school leadership and external authorities when required. The DSL ensures that safeguarding decisions are informed, timely, and centred on the child's best interests.

All staff and adults working with children at Edenbridge Grammar are expected to remain vigilant, to recognise potential safeguarding concerns, and to report any worries immediately in accordance with school procedures. Staff must follow safeguarding guidance consistently and uphold professional boundaries at all times. Failure to report safeguarding concerns is treated as a serious matter.

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6. Reporting and Responding to Safeguarding Concerns

Edenbridge Grammar maintains clear and structured procedures for responding to safeguarding concerns. When a concern is identified or disclosed, the immediate safety of the child is prioritised. The concern must be reported without delay to the Designated Safeguarding Lead, who will ensure that it is recorded confidentially and accurately.

Appropriate action is then taken based on the nature and severity of the concern. This may involve internal support, engagement with parents where appropriate and safe, or referral to external authorities. Where ongoing risk is identified, the school provides continued monitoring and support.

Children are never pressured to disclose information, questioned excessively, or made to repeat their experiences unnecessarily. All responses are guided by care, sensitivity, and respect.

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7. Student Voice and Support

Edenbridge Grammar places strong emphasis on listening to students and ensuring they feel confident to speak up. Students are encouraged to share concerns with a trusted adult, mentor, or teacher and are reassured that asking for help will never result in punishment.

Safeguarding education is provided in an age-appropriate and respectful manner, helping students understand personal safety, boundaries, digital responsibility, and where to seek support. The school works to ensure that students feel heard, valued, and protected.

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8. Digital, Internet, and AI Safeguarding

Safeguarding at Edenbridge Grammar extends fully into digital learning environments, including the use of AI-supported educational tools. Our School ensures that technology is used in a safe, monitored, and educationally purposeful manner at all times.

Digital safeguarding measures include controlled access to online platforms, clear guidance on appropriate online behaviour, and active staff oversight of digital communication. AI-supported learning tools operate within closed systems, with safeguarding guardrails, content filters, and monitoring in place. Any concerning language, behaviour, or emotional indicators trigger alerts that are reviewed by trained staff.

Digital safeguarding applies both on-site and during online or blended learning. No digital system operates without human oversight, and no safeguarding concern is addressed by technology alone.

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9. Confidentiality and Information Sharing

Safeguarding information at Edenbridge Grammar is handled with the highest level of confidentiality. Information is shared strictly on a need-to-know basis and stored securely in accordance with data protection requirements.

Families are involved in safeguarding matters where appropriate and safe to do so. However, where there is a risk of harm to a child, the child's safety overrides confidentiality or parental notification. Decisions regarding information sharing are made carefully and ethically, with the child's wellbeing as the guiding priority.

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10. Staff Conduct and Professional Boundaries

All adults working at Edenbridge Grammar are expected to act as positive role models and to maintain appropriate physical, emotional, and professional boundaries at all times. Staff must use professional language and behaviour, avoid situations that could place themselves or students at risk, and ensure transparency in one-to-one interactions.

Any breach of professional conduct is addressed immediately and in line with school procedures. Maintaining trust, safety, and integrity is essential to safeguarding practice.

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11. Training, Monitoring, and Review

Safeguarding training is mandatory for all staff at Edenbridge Grammar and is provided regularly to ensure understanding of procedures, responsibilities, and emerging risks. Refresher training and updates are delivered as needed, particularly in relation to digital safeguarding and AI-supported learning.

This policy is reviewed annually, or sooner if required by changes in legislation, safeguarding guidance, or school practice.

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12. Safeguarding and Islamic Values

Safeguarding at Edenbridge Grammar is deeply rooted in Islamic values that emphasise the dignity, protection, and care of every child. Principles such as **Amanah (trust)**, **Adab (respect)**, **Haya (modesty)**, **Rahmah (compassion)**, and **responsibility for the vulnerable** guide all safeguarding practice.

Protecting children from harm, preserving their dignity, and acting with justice and care are understood as moral and religious responsibilities, not only legal obligations.

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13. Core Safeguarding Principle

At Edenbridge Grammar, every child has the right to feel **safe, respected, heard, and protected**.

Safeguarding is not a single policy or procedure; it is a shared responsibility, a daily practice, and a fundamental expression of the school's values and commitment to its students.

Approval

Approved by: _____

CEO: _____

Academic Director: _____

Position: _____

Date: _____

Next Review Date: _____